Versioning APIs can be very challenging if versioning is a strategy within the project's API development process. With Pact, the consumer and provider have a version associated with a contract. Specific Pact contracts get verified. Pact Broker pairs the consumer and provider versions to form the verification status. Figure 9.4 shows that provider version 2.0.1 can successfully interact with the consumer but not version 3.0.1.

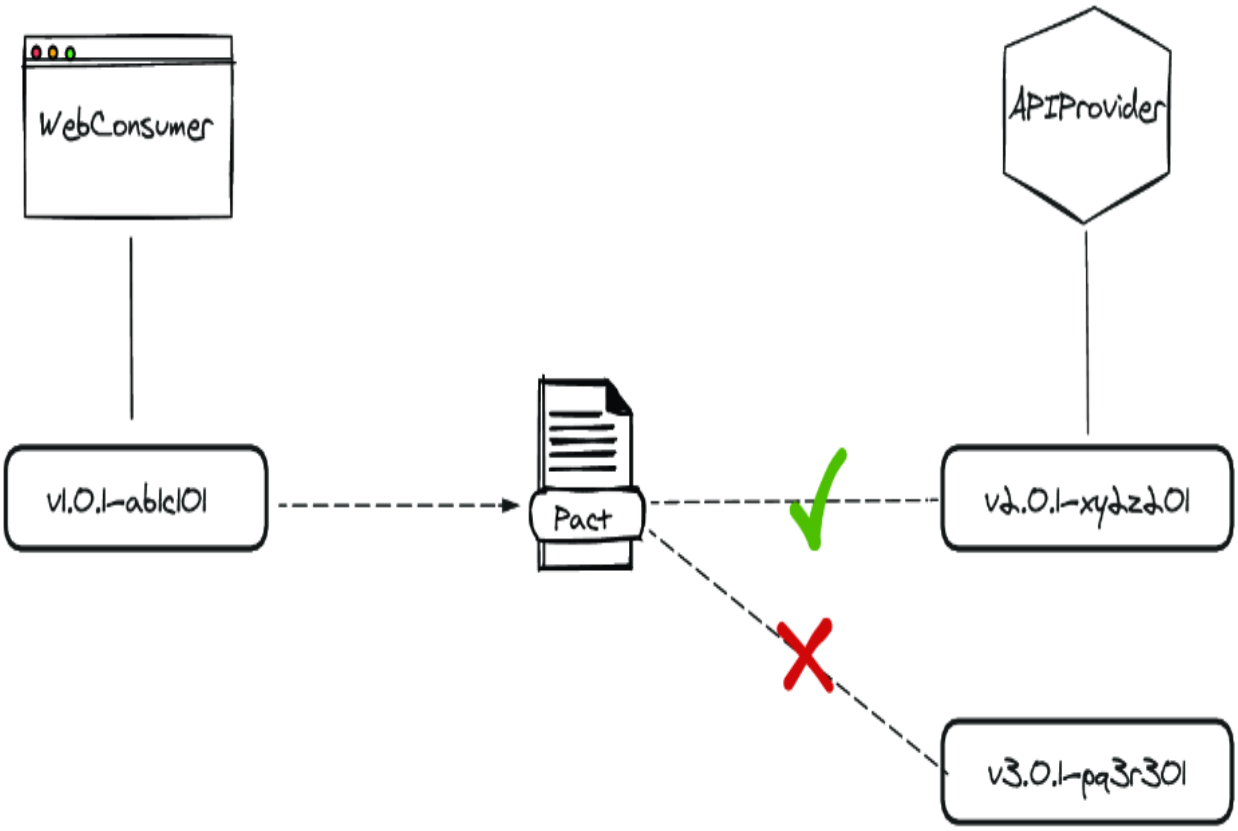


Figure 9.4 Consumer and provider versions associated with the Pact contract form the verification status.

Best practices from Pact documentation (https://mng.bz/r14D) suggest the following:

- The consumer version updates anytime the Pact contract changes.
- App version numbers should be unique.

Pact is very clever regarding multiple consumer contract versions; if the contract file hasn't changed in content, Pact Broker can infer verification status. Verifications don't need to be repeated when the contract file hasn't changed.